

Lectio Divina Meditation

Take the meditation posture by sitting upright. Straighten your neck as you lower your chin a little. Allow your shoulders to fall back. Scan your body for tension and release it on the exhale. You might use the word “calm” to center yourself. Breathe and prepare for one minute. *(Pause 1 minute)*

1. Read the passage

I will read a short phrase from the Bible and then pause. You might wish to allow the phrase to rise and fall in your mind with your breath. Our phrase is from the first chapter of James, verse 4:

*Give endurance a chance to accomplish its oriented outcome.
(Repeat) (Pause 10 seconds)*

2. Receive as you listen

Relax while I read the phrase three times, pausing between readings. Take the attitude of a listener and consider your experience with this phrase. In the stillness between the readings, allow a feeling, a thought, or an image to come to mind that may be related to the phrase. If nothing comes to mind, observe the absence, or just enjoy the stillness. Observe with compassion any other feelings or thoughts that may intrude, and then return to the phrase. Let's begin.

*Give endurance a chance to accomplish its oriented outcome.
(Read 3 times with a 30 second pause after each reading)*

3. Respond

No matter what your experience may be, respond to God with affirmation and gratitude. *(Pause 30 seconds)*

4. Rest in awareness

Rest in stillness for one minute as you contemplate whatever has happened during this time. You might allow the phrase to gently recede, and then focus your mind on your breath. *(Pause 1 minute)*

Pause and re-engage with your environment. You may wish to take this next minute to rest or to record your experience, perhaps in your KF journal or on your **Meeting Preparation Guide**. *(Pause 1 minute)*

And pause. This meditation is most often used with longer passages from Scripture. Try spending more time on each step or use the same passage every day for a week.